Reviewer 3 v.1

Comments to the Author

Abeldano et al performed a meta-analysis of the trials addressing convalescent plasma in hospitalized patients with covid-19. They conclude that convalescent plasma cannot reduce the mortality or ventilation requirement in hospitalized patients with covid-19.

Major comments

Trial selection and randomization

The trials that were assessed are displayed in the electronical supplement. The Simonovich trial (A Randomized Trial of Convalescent Plasma in Covid-19 Severe Pneumonia, N Engl J Med Nov 2020) is not referred to. The Gharbharan trial (Convalescent Plasma for COVID-19. A randomized clinical trial. medRxiv 2020.07.01.20139857; doi: https://doi.org/10.1101/2020.07.01.20139857, prematurely interrupted) should be discussed. The Abolghasami trial has been selected by the authors but is not randomized. Interestingly, it is unclear whether the authors consider it randomized (page 8, line 23), or not (table 1). The issue of randomization in the selected trials should be addressed seriously as it is one of the most important way to reduce selection biases (which is obvious in the Abolghasami trial) and favor group comparability (which is difficult in hospitalized COVID-19 patient).

Additional comments

The conclusion should not be so definitive, in particular because of the flaws in the methodologies of the selected trials. These flaws (risk of bias) should be displayed in the result section of the abstract (not only in the conclusion).

A description of the quality of the plasma used, in terms of neutralizing antibodies against SARS-coV-2 should be provided.